HAOTALK / LEVEL 1 / SCENE 01

Food & Drinks on the Plane

A little Chinese for the journey before you land.

飞机上的餐饮服务

Choose a meal, ask for a drink and request a blanket. Use this guide with the six-step lesson on HaoDays. The lesson video will be added later.

Your learning route

01 Watch the scene

02 Understand the dialogue

03 Learn words and patterns

04 Listen for the meaning

05 Speak in a new situation

06 Review and revisit

Three phrases to take on board

有咖啡吗?

Yǒu kāfēi ma?
Do you have coffee?

我要茶，谢谢。

Wǒ yào chá, xièxie.
I'd like tea, thank you.

有毯子吗?

Yǒu tǎnzi ma?
Do you have a blanket?

HAOTALK / LEVEL 1 / 02 / DIALOGUE

The full conversation / 1

Read the Chinese first. Use pinyin and English when you need a little help.

01 / Flight attendant

您好，吃什么?

Nín hǎo, chī shénme?

Hello, what would you like to eat?

02 / Alex

有什么?

Yǒu shénme?

What's available?

03 / Flight attendant

鸡肉饭还是牛肉面?

Jīròu fàn háishi niúròu miàn?

Chicken rice or beef noodles?

04 / Alex

鸡肉饭吧，谢谢。

Jīròu fàn ba, xièxie.

I'll have the chicken rice, thanks.

05 / Flight attendant

好的。您要喝什么?

Hǎo de. Nín yào hē shénme?

Sure. What would you like to drink?

06 / Alex

有咖啡吗?

Yǒu kāfēi ma?

Do you have coffee?

07 / Flight attendant

有的。

Yǒu de.

Yes, we do.

08 / Alex

我要咖啡，谢谢。

Wǒ yào kāfēi, xièxie.

I'll have coffee, thank you.

HAOTALK / LEVEL 1 / 02 / DIALOGUE

The full conversation / 2

Read the Chinese first. Use pinyin and English when you need a little help.

09 / Flight attendant

要加冰吗?

Yào jiā bīng ma?

Would you like ice in it?

10 / Alex

要，谢谢。

Yào, xièxie.

Yes, please.

11 / Flight attendant

好的，给您。

Hǎo de, gěi nín.

Sure, here you go.

12 / Alex

有毯子吗?

Yǒu tǎnzi ma?

Do you have a blanket?

13 / Flight attendant

有，稍等一下。

Yǒu, shāo děng yíxià.

Yes, just a moment.

14 / Flight attendant

给您。

Gěi nín.

Here you go.

15 / Alex

谢谢!

Xièxie!

Thank you!

16 / Flight attendant

不客气。

Bú kèqi.

You're welcome.

HAOTALK / LEVEL 1 / 03 / LEARN

Words you can reuse

Keep the same sentence pattern and change the item in the middle.

Core words & expressions

CHINESE	PINYIN	ENGLISH
鸡肉饭	jīròu fàn	chicken rice
牛肉面	niúròu miàn	beef noodles
咖啡	kāfēi	coffee
有	yǒu	to have / there is
要	yào	to want / would like
还是	háishi	or (in a choice question)
需要	xūyào	to need
加冰	jiā bīng	to add ice
毯子	tǎnzi	blanket
稍等一下	shāo děng yíxià	just a moment

More useful words

CHINESE	PINYIN	ENGLISH
水	shuǐ	water
茶	chá	tea
果汁	guǒzhī	juice
米饭	mǐfàn	cooked rice
面条	miàntiáo	noodles
纸巾	zhǐjīn	tissue / napkin
牛肉饭	niúròu fàn	beef rice
面包	miànbāo	bread

HAOTALK / LEVEL 1 / 03 / PATTERNS

Two patterns. Many uses.

Try replacing coffee with another drink, a food or something you need.

01 / Ask if something is available

有 + 物品 + 吗?

Put the item between 有 and 吗. The final 吗 turns the sentence into a yes-or-no question.

有咖啡吗?
Yǒu kāfēi ma?
Do you have coffee?

有水吗?
Yǒu shuǐ ma?
Do you have water?

有毯子吗?
Yǒu tǎnzi ma?
Do you have a blanket?

02 / Say what you would like

我要 + 物品

Use 我要 to make a simple request. Add 谢谢 to make it friendly and polite.

我要咖啡，谢谢。
Wǒ yào kāfēi, xièxie.
I'd like coffee, thank you.

我要茶，谢谢。
Wǒ yào chá, xièxie.
I'd like tea, thank you.

我要牛肉面，谢谢。
Wǒ yào niúròu miàn, xièxie.
I'd like beef noodles, thank you.

HAOTALK / LEVEL 1 / 03 / EVERYDAY CHINESE

Short replies, naturally

Listen for these useful expressions when someone is serving food or helping you.

鸡肉饭吧。

Jīròu fàn ba.
I'll go with the chicken rice.

吧 softens a choice. You can answer with just the meal plus 吧.

加冰。 / 不加冰。

Jiā bīng. / Bù jiā bīng.
With ice. / No ice.

冰 (bīng) means ice. Use 不 before 加冰 when you do not want any.

要，谢谢。 / 不要，谢谢。

Yào, xièxie. / Bú yào, xièxie.
Yes, please. / No, thank you.

Short answers are natural. 不用□谢谢 (Bú yòng, xièxie) is another polite way to decline.

给您。

Gěi nín.
Here you go.

Listen for this when someone hands you a drink, a meal or a blanket.

稍等一下。

Shāo děng yíxià.
Just a moment.

A common reply when someone is getting something for you.

Pronunciation note: 要□谢谢 is Yào, xièxie. 不要 is pronounced bú yào in connected speech, while 不加冰 is bù jiā bīng.

HAOTALK / LEVEL 1 / 04 / LISTEN

Listen for the meaning

Use the audio in the online lesson. In this printable guide, you can also read the Chinese prompt. Answers are at the back.

01 / What is the flight attendant asking?

鸡肉饭还是牛肉面?

A. Which drink you would like

B. Which meal you would like

C. Where you are going

02 / What does Alex want to know?

有咖啡吗?

A. Whether coffee is available

B. Whether ice is available

C. How much coffee costs

03 / What is the flight attendant checking?

要加冰吗?

A. Whether you need a blanket

B. Whether you would like ice

C. Whether you would like noodles

HAOTALK / LEVEL 1 / 05 / SPEAK

Make it your own

Say your answer aloud before looking at the reference answers. More than one natural answer may work.

01. Ask if water is available.

Your answer: _____

02. Say you would like tea. Make it polite.

Your answer: _____

03. You are asked 要加冰吗□ Say no, thank you.

Your answer: _____

04. You are feeling cold. Ask for a blanket.

Your answer: _____

Role-play: a different order

Choose beef noodles, tea without ice and a blanket. Answer each prompt as the passenger.

Turn 01 / You want beef noodles.

鸡肉饭还是牛肉面?

Your response: _____

Turn 02 / Ask if tea is available.

您要喝什么?

Your response: _____

Turn 03 / Tell the flight attendant you would like tea.

有的。

Your response: _____

Turn 04 / You would like no ice.

要加冰吗?

Your response: _____

Turn 05 / Ask for a blanket.

还需要什么吗?

Your response: _____

HAOTALK / LEVEL 1 / 06 / REVIEW

Remember it. Use it.

Cover the Chinese in the earlier pages. Read these English prompts and say them in Mandarin.

01. Do you have coffee?

Your answer: _____

02. I'd like tea, thank you.

Your answer: _____

03. Do you have a blanket?

Your answer: _____

04. No ice, thank you.

Your answer: _____

Quick check

1. Which question asks whether water is available?

A. 我要水。
B. 有水吗?
C. 水在哪里?

2. What does 给您 mean when a drink is handed to you?

A. Just a moment.
B. Would you like ice?
C. Here you go.

Tomorrow: make two new 有……吗□ questions and two 我要…… sentences. Try the dialogue with pinyin and English hidden. Tick a confidence card online only when you can say it without looking.

HAOTALK / LEVEL 1 / ANSWER KEY / 01

Check your understanding

Use these references after trying the activities yourself.

Listening check

1. B / Which meal you would like

还是 offers a choice: chicken rice or beef noodles.

2. A / Whether coffee is available

有……吗□ asks whether something is available. 咖啡 means coffee.

3. B / Whether you would like ice

加冰 means add ice. You can answer 要□谢谢 or 不要□谢谢.

Speaking prompts

Prompt 01

有水吗?

Yǒu shuǐ ma?

Do you have water?

Prompt 02

我要茶，谢谢。

Wǒ yào chá, xièxie.

I'd like tea, thank you.

Prompt 03

不要，谢谢。

Bú yào, xièxie.

No, thank you.

Prompt 04

有毯子吗?

Yǒu tǎnzi ma?

Do you have a blanket?

Quick check

1. B / 有 + an item + 吗□ asks if it is available. 我要水 states that you would like water.

2. C / 给您 is the polite expression for handing something over. 稍等一下 means just a moment.

HAOTALK / LEVEL 1 / ANSWER KEY / 02

Your conversation, again

Reference responses for the five role-play turns. Other natural answers can also work.

Turn 01 / You want beef noodles.

牛肉面吧，谢谢。

Niúròu miàn ba, xièxie.

Turn 02 / Ask if tea is available.

有茶吗?

Yǒu chá ma?

Turn 03 / Tell the flight attendant you would like tea.

那我要茶，谢谢。

Nà wǒ yào chá, xièxie.

Turn 04 / You would like no ice.

不加冰，谢谢。

Bù jiā bīng, xièxie.

Turn 05 / Ask for a blanket.

有毯子吗?

Yǒu tǎnzi ma?

Quick recall references

有咖啡吗?

Yǒu kāfēi ma?

Do you have coffee?

我要茶，谢谢。

Wǒ yào chá, xièxie.

I'd like tea, thank you.

有毯子吗?

Yǒu tǎnzi ma?

Do you have a blanket?

不加冰，谢谢。

Bù jiā bīng, xièxie.

No ice, thank you.